

Figure 2: Table wizard dialogue box

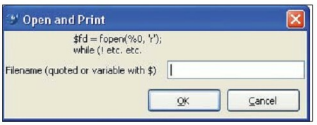


Figure 3: Open file and print

clues to programmers. This helps in readability and finding syntax errors. Some popular languages supported by Bluefish are listed below:

- ASP .NET and VBS
- C/C++
- CSS
- CFML
- Clojure
- D
- HTML, XHTML and HTML5
- Java and JSP
- JavaScript and jQuery
- MediaWiki, Wordpress
- Perl
- PHP
- Python
- R
- Ruby
- Shell
- Scheme
- SQL
- XML

Auto completion

For all the programming languages that Bluefish supports, the auto completion functionality is available. This makes coding much easier and also less error prone. After typing the first letter of the keyword, the editor gives a dropdown list of suggestions.

Dialogues and wizards

In Web development, especially, mistakes in scripting or mark-up can lead to hours of debugging. To reduce the time for debugging, Bluefish comes with a feature to write code with the help of dialogue boxes and wizards.

For example, the dialogue box is for creating an HTML table. The user needs to enter a few values like the dimensions and pick up values like colour. This wizard also gives an exhaustive list of attributes, which enables programmers to use the right attribute to achieve the desired result.

Support for remote files like FTP, SFTP, HTTP and WebDAV

This feature is seen in Linux systems. Bluefish opens remote files using FTP, SFTP and HTTP protocols, and offers the same convenience as local files. You can view and also modify remote files. This feature is useful for Web development and for publishing it online.

Snippets

In programming, we come across frequently used chunks of text. Some examples of such text in Web programming could be: opening a database connection, creating a table, opening a file and reading it. The following snippet is generated when a user chooses *'PHP'-> File -> Open and Print.*

```
$fd = fopen(README, 'r');
while (!feof($fd)) {
    $buffer = fgets($fd, 4096);
    echo $buffer;
}
fclose($fd);
```

To maximise the benefit of a feature, you can enforce coding standards and also train newcomers by creating sets of snippets frequently used in projects. While one of the programmers creates the set of snippets and exports it into a file, other programmers can import it into the editors for coding. Creating snippets is extremely simple.

Auto recovery of files

This feature avoids loss of text or work due to system crashes. There is a temporary file that is frequently saved while editing is going on. If the system crashes before the next file-save, Bluefish recovers files from a temporary store and ensures changes are not lost. END

References

[1] Bluefish Project Home - *http://bluefish.openoffice.nl/index.html*
[2] Bluefish: The Definitive Guide - *http://bluefish.openoffice.nl/manual/bk01-toc.html*
[3] Create Web Pages 5 Times Faster - *http://www.makeuseof.com/tag/createweb-pages-faster-bluefish-editor/*
[4] Hidden Features of Bluefish - *http://bfwiki.tellefsen.net/index.php/Hidden_features*
[5] 7 Linux Web Editors Compared - *http://www.techradar.com/news/internet/web/7-linux-web-editors-that-get-the-job-done-499389?artc_pg=1*

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